



Dr D Lavanian
Business Manager
Apollo Group of Hospitals

We use video conferencing for telemedicine. Our doctors use it to interact with patients and the referring doctor. This supplements the patient's electronic medical record on Medintegra, our telemedicine application. These records help specialist doctors formulate opinions. They also specify a treatment regimen, which is then entered into Medintegra and carried out by the referring doctor. We seek the opinion of two specialists, each from a different city using video conferencing. Even our continuing education programmes are conducted using video conferencing from anywhere between three to ten cities. Our infrastructure includes a colour TV (20-inch flat, 29-inch flat and 42-inch plasma models), a good quality sound system, three ISDN lines (128 Kbps each) or broadband Internet—256 Kbps dedicated—with a public static IP address, VCR for recording certain cases, clean power with backup, computers with video-out to view images, medical equipment, Polycom Image and Audio Equipment, as well as Aethra. It lowers the total cost of treatment.

IN CAMERA!



Sunil Buch
Head, Marketing and
Production Management
Reliance Infocomm

Video conferencing is a way of life at Reliance. Bundling video conferencing as part of the Reliance Web World network in 111 cities made business sense. They are connected with three T1 lines. Video conferencing is a business model because the enterprise client just has to pay for the services, while we take care of infrastructure and training. All you need to do is just walk into any Web World, and check in for the services. Our Churchgate Webstore, for instance, was used to record the statement of a witness for a court case. This is perfectly legal. Gillette did a product launch through our Web World network using video conferencing. It has been used by Bollywood, too. We ran a contest for *Kal Ho Na Ho* on R-World and had the winners speak to Preity Zinta and Karan Johar via a video conference. In the near future, we see enterprises as our biggest customers. We plan to push our services as a means to overcome distance, and for people to make their presence felt.



Yugal Sharma
Country Manager
Polycom

Video conferencing is no longer looked at by corporates and enterprises as a fancy way of communicating. It is now a necessity. Most enterprises have decentralised decision-making, and yet it is important for the head office to make certain strategic decisions. Video conferencing allows companies to make these decisions instantly. The technology has evolved over the years. It started out with large screens in conference rooms, but now we have desktop conferencing which denecessitates the setting up of a conference room, thereby reducing costs further. Small enterprises such as lawyers, consultants, exporters, etc, can use it to maximise their business revenue. Video conferencing has been around in India for more than 15 years, but it is only in the last five years that it has been accepted as a way of doing business. The National Informatics Centre has nearly 80 locations in Maharashtra connected via video conferencing. Our estimate of the Indian video conferencing market is about \$50 million (around Rs 230 crore).

As told to Garfield D'Souza